

Black Cloud

Black Cloud Definition: This is a scenario where the lack of informal communication channels and transparency creates knowledge silos among team members, who end up communicating almost exclusively with their manager, resulting in a communication bottleneck caused by the organizational structure.

Key Aspect to Emphasize: The fundamental aspect to highlight is the communication bottleneck that develops when the manager becomes the single point of contact for information exchange, causing a lack of global knowledge within the team and the manager's overload.

Setting: When the lecturer presses Play, the four actors appear seated at their desks and work frantically at their computers. The manager appears standing in front of them. Throughout the scene, the lecturer speaks providing context.

Action	What happens	What the lecturer does
1	A project timeline appears as a graphic element above the desks and begins to advance. It doesn't start from zero, but is already almost at 3/4 and reads "Delivery deadline".	The lecturer explains who they are, what they are doing, and the current project situation.
2	Ver 1: A mute symbol appears over the actors' heads. Ver 2: Walls appear between each pair of desks. The actors appear even more frustrated.	The lecturer explains the symbolism of isolation and the inability to communicate within the team.
3	Piles of documents begin to fall and accumulate at the team members' desks.	The lecturer explains that this represents the accumulation of information that does not travel between team members.
4	The dark aura is now clearly visible. The actors show difficulty within the cloud.	The lecturer explains that the cloud indicates a lack of global knowledge and that they will only be able to communicate with their manager.
5	The manager is visibly frustrated. A graphic window appears with several messages the manager is receiving from the team. The progress bar is now red.	The lecturer explains the manager's state of being overwhelmed by messages.
6	A graphic window appears above the desks covered by the aura, with messages the manager is sending to the obscured team. The bar reaches the end.	The lecturer explains the final attempt at communication as time runs out.

7	The manager is frustrated and the team is demoralized. The text “Black Cloud” appears.	The lecturer explains that the time is up and the project has failed.
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Unmanaged Lone Wolf

Lone Wolf Definition: This is a scenario in which a team member isolates themselves and works alone, avoiding communication with colleagues. A similar situation leads to tasks executed in isolation and loss of control over project tracking, as well as general group dissatisfaction.

Key aspect to emphasize: The aspect that is important to emphasize is not just the isolation of a team member and acting disrespectfully towards peers, but also the manager who does nothing active to resolve the situation.

Setting: When the lecturer presses Play, the actors (the manager and three team members) appear standing close together. Behind them, a screen displays a piece of code. The group is portrayed engaging in a discussion about the code during a peer review.

Action	What happens	What the lecturer does
1	The team is in a good mood, and a happy emoji appears above them.	The lecturer explains that the team is discussing a code snippet during a peer review phase with the team.
2	The manager notices that something is wrong; a question mark appears above his head, and shortly after, the missing team member appears working alone at her desk, distant from the others.	The lecturer explains that the manager realizes something is wrong, highlighting the team member working in isolation and showing no interest in participating in the group activity. The lecturer then emphasizes that this is not an isolated incident and happens frequently, but the manager, fearing conflict, has never acted decisively.
3	The team members at the meeting start complaining about the lone wolf. One by one, symbols of discontent or expressions of frustration appear above their heads. The team members exclaim phrases such as: “He rewrote all my code without asking me!” or “Why does he keep using	The lecturer explains that the manager took no active steps, which over time led to growing resentment and anger within the team, ultimately resulting in a decline in the mood.

	PascalCase when we agreed to do everything in camelCase!”	
4	Above the lone wolf, the message “I don’t care” appears, indicating their lack of interest in group activities. The team members now have an angry emoji filled with symbols of frustration, representing their growing desire to abandon the project or their diminishing motivation to work.	The lecturer explains that the lack of action has worsened the situation, and now everything is out of control, with the team no longer functioning effectively.
5	The phrase “UNMANAGED LONE WOLF” appears in large text.	The lecturer then proceeds with the explanation of the smell.

Radio Silence

Radio Silence Definition: This is a scenario in which bosses and team members execute tasks following an extremely formal and complex organization. In this way, the communication structures do not allow for an efficient exchange of information between teams.

Key aspect to emphasize: The aspect that is important to emphasize is how the lack of flexibility in communication between team members, with the consequent choice of a single individual as a junction point, leads to an inefficient exchange of information. Such a situation causes (1) loss of information, (2) lowering of morale, and (3) project delays.

Setting: When the lecturer presses Play, the manager appears standing with his team on his left. The group is located on the left of the scene (students' perspective).

Action	What happens	What the lecturer does
1	To the right of the manager, the second manager (Ruggero) appears and the two begin to communicate. Above them, something appears indicating the need to collaborate; it could be a drawing with a circle and stylized faces of the managers on both sides. Besides this, the project completion time bar could also appear (as in the first smell).	The lecturer explains that at this stage it is necessary to collaborate with another team. Presents the second manager and illustrates that the two teams must structure a way to communicate since they are geographically distributed.
2	Ruggero remains in the far right part of the scene and the manager indicates Giulia, who positions herself between the two groups (Tonio and the 3 team members and Ruggero).	The lecturer explains that a strategy based on an individual who will manage communication between the two groups solely is chosen. Presents Giulia as such an individual and describes her tasks. Justifies the choice saying that corporate policy is to reduce horizontal communication between employees.
3	The exchange of information begins, represented by the sending of emails between the two groups and Giulia. Giulia could have a phone in her hand or a video chat behind her, indicating communication. Tonio's team members are shown working at their desks.	The lecturer explains that communication begins. Emphasizes how Giulia is the only junction point.
4	Giulia begins to be overwhelmed by communications and unable to manage them. Papers appear around her (one on top of the other) and she begins to look tired and agitated. Manager Tonio also begins to look agitated.	The lecturer explains how identifying a single junction point between groups cannot scale over time and that the choice not to allow communication between team members forces Giulia to

		do excessive work. This delays the arrival of information and the work.
5	The bar exceeds the deadline and everything starts to get worse and worse. Symbols of annoyance and stress also begin to appear on the team members' heads.	The lecturer explains that the choice led to a project failure due to delay.
6	The words RADIO SILENCE appear	The lecturer explains the smell.